

Problem #3: Cherokee Numerals

Solution:

Numbers from one to ten are specific words, namely *sowo* [1], *tali* [2], *tsoi* [3], *nvgi* [4], *hisgi* [5], *sudali* [6], *galiquogi* [7], and *sgohi* [10]. The words for 8 and 9 are *tsunela* and *sonela* respectively, which cannot be inferred from the given data and are not required to solve this problem. From eleven to nineteen, numbers are built by adding the suffix **-du** after the unit which can slightly change phonetically: *talidu* = *tali+du* = 12, *hisgadu* = *hisga+du* = 15, etc. The tens are formed by adding the suffix **-sgohi** at the end of the matching digit: *hisgisgohi* = *hisgi+sgohi* [50], *sudalisgohi* = *sudali+sgohi* = 60 etc. From twenty-one to ninety-nine, the numbers are made by saying the ten with its last syllable **-hi** removed, then the unit. Thus, 65 = 60 + 5 = *sudalisgohi* + *hisgi* = *sudalisgo hisgi*.

Note that 1 is *sowo*, but whenever it comes as the unit place digit in a two digit number, the form “*sawo*” is used.

Assignment 1 Correspondence			
Cherokee	Translation	Cherokee	Translation
sudalisgo hisgi	65	talidu	12
sowo	1	nvgisgo sawo	41
hisgadu	15	tsoigo tsoi	33
hisgi	5	galiquadu	17
galiquogi	7	hisgisgohi	50
galiquasgohi	70	galiquasgo sudali	76
talisgohi	20	daladu	16
Assignment 2	Cherokee Translations		
36	tsoigo sudali		
55	hisgisgo hisgi		
6	sudali		
60	sudalisgohi		
21	talisgo sawo		
Assignment 3	Answers		
talisgo sudali	26		
sudalisgo sudali	66		
hisgisgo nvgis	54		
